

EXPLANATION

1. Passage anchor

> “Whenever a student got stuck, she seemed to pull out exactly the right **explanation**.”

Passage meaning

explanation = a statement or set of ideas that makes something easier to understand

解釋；說明

Here, Ms. Lau can choose the most suitable way to explain a difficult concept whenever a student gets stuck.

Practice

1. Her **explanation** made the difficult idea much clearer.

她的**解釋**讓那個困難概念清楚得多。

2. I finally understood the topic after hearing a different **explanation**.

我聽到另一種**解釋方式**後，終於理解了這個主題。

Core meanings of EXPLANATION

2. explanation — something that makes an idea clear

= words or information that help someone understand something

解釋；說明

Examples

1. The teacher gave a clear **explanation** of the theory.

老師對這個理論作了清楚的**解釋**。

2. I need a simpler **explanation**.

我需要一個更簡單的**說明**。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. explanation of something

= description or account that helps someone understand a particular thing

****對.....的解釋 / 說明****

Examples

1. Her ****explanation of the experiment**** was very clear.
她對這個實驗的****解釋****非常清楚。
2. The book gives a useful ****explanation of gravity****.
這本書對重力作了有用的****說明****。

4. give an explanation

= explain something to someone

****作出解釋；給予說明****

Examples

1. He gave a detailed ****explanation****.
他作了詳細的****解釋****。
2. The teacher gave us an ****explanation**** of the formula.
老師向我們****解釋了那條公式****。

Reason / cause

5. explanation — reason why something happened

= a reason or account that explains why something happened or exists

****原因；解釋****

Examples

1. There must be an ****explanation**** for the sudden change.
這個突然的變化一定有某種****原因 / 解釋****。
2. Scientists are looking for an ****explanation**** for the result.
科學家正在尋找這個結果的****原因 / 解釋****。

This is a major distinct branch.

6. explanation for something

= reason that accounts for an event, behavior, or result

.....的原因 / 解釋

Examples

1. What is the **explanation for the delay**?

延誤的**原因**是甚麼？

2. There is no simple **explanation for his behavior**.

他的行為沒有簡單的**解釋**。

Account / justification

7. explanation — account given to justify or defend something

= statement given to explain or justify an action, mistake, or situation

交代；解釋；說明

Examples

1. The manager asked for an **explanation**.

經理要求他作出**解釋**。

2. She owed them an **explanation** for leaving suddenly.

她突然離開，理應給他們一個**交代**。

This often carries a social or accountability nuance.

8. demand / ask for an explanation

= require someone to explain their actions or a situation

要求解釋 / 交代

Examples

1. The teacher **asked for an explanation**.

老師要求作出**解釋**。

2. The board **demanded an explanation** for the missing funds.

董事會要求就失款一事作出**交代**。

Scientific / theoretical account

9. explanation — account of how or why something works

= theory or account that explains a phenomenon

解釋；機制說明；理論說明

Examples

1. The theory offers an **explanation** for the observed pattern.

這個理論為觀察到的模式提供了一個**解釋**。

2. Researchers proposed several possible **explanations**.

研究人員提出了幾種可能的**解釋**。

10. possible explanation

= one plausible reason or account among several

可能的解釋

Examples

1. One **possible explanation** is measurement error.

一個**可能的解釋**是測量誤差。

2. The study discusses several **possible explanations**.

這項研究討論了幾種**可能的解釋**。

Clarification

11. explanation — clarification of meaning or instructions

= further information that removes confusion

說明；澄清

Examples

1. Could you give me a little more **explanation**?

你可以再多作一點**說明**嗎？

2. The diagram needs some **explanation**.

這張圖需要一些**說明**。

Teaching / pedagogy

12. clear explanation

= explanation that is easy to understand

清楚的解釋

Examples

1. A **clear explanation** can make a difficult topic much easier.

清楚的**解釋**能讓困難主題變容易很多。

2. Students benefit from **clear explanations** and examples.

學生能從**清楚的解釋**和例子中受益。

13. simple explanation

= explanation using easy language or a simple structure

簡單易懂的解釋

Examples

1. Can you give me a **simple explanation**?

你可以給我一個**簡單易懂的解釋**嗎？

2. She always found a **simple explanation** for difficult ideas.

她總能為困難概念找到**簡單的解釋方式**。

14. detailed explanation

= explanation containing a lot of relevant detail

詳細解釋；詳細說明

Examples

1. The textbook provides a **detailed explanation**.

課本提供了**詳細說明**。

2. He gave a **detailed explanation** of the process.
他對這個過程作了**詳細解釋**。

Fixed expressions

15. no explanation

= no known or satisfactory reason/account

沒有解釋；原因不明

Examples

1. There was **no explanation** for the sudden failure.
突然故障**原因不明**。

2. He left without any **explanation**.
他沒有作任何**解釋**就離開了。

16. without explanation

= without saying why

沒有解釋地；未作說明

Examples

1. The meeting was cancelled **without explanation**.
會議在**沒有說明原因**的情況下取消了。

2. She disappeared **without explanation**.
她**沒有任何交代**就消失了。

17. owe someone an explanation

= have a responsibility to explain your actions to someone

欠某人一個交代 / 有責任向某人解釋

Examples

1. You **owe me an explanation**.

你**欠我一個解釋 / 交代**。

2. He felt he **owed his team an explanation**.

他覺得自己**有責任向團隊作出解釋**。

Related forms

18. explain

= make something clear or understandable by giving information or reasons

解釋 ; 說明

Examples

1. She **explained the idea** clearly.

她清楚地**解釋了這個概念**。

2. Can you **explain why this happened**?

你可以**解釋為甚麼會發生這件事**嗎？

19. explain something to someone

= make something understandable for a particular person

向某人解釋某事

Examples

1. She **explained the formula to us**.

她**向我們解釋了那條公式**。

2. Can you **explain this to me**?

你可以**向我解釋這件事**嗎？

Important grammar pattern.

Not:

> *explain me this* ✗

20. explain why / how

= give the reason or process behind something

****解釋為甚麼 / 如何****

Examples

1. He ****explained why the result changed****.

他****解釋了為甚麼結果會改變****。

2. She ****explained how the system works****.

她****解釋了系統如何運作****。

21. explanatory

= intended to explain or clarify something

****解釋性的；說明性的****

Examples

1. The diagram includes ****explanatory notes****.

圖表附有****說明文字****。

2. She added an ****explanatory paragraph****.

她加了一段****解釋性文字****。

22. self-explanatory

= clear enough to understand without further explanation

****不言自明的；無需解釋的****

Examples

1. The instructions are largely ****self-explanatory****.

這些說明大致上****一看就懂****。

2. The chart is ****self-explanatory****.

這張圖表****不需要額外解釋****。

Countability

23. explanation is usually countable

Common:

- * an explanation
- * one explanation
- * several explanations

Examples

1. She gave me ****an explanation****.
她給了我一個****解釋****。
2. There are several possible ****explanations****.
有幾種可能的****解釋****。

It can also appear more generally without an article in phrases like:

> without explanation

Key contrasts

24. explanation vs reason

****reason****

= cause or motive for something

****原因 ; 理由****

****explanation****

= account that makes the cause, meaning, or situation understandable

****解釋 ; 說明****

Compare:

> The ****reason**** for the delay was bad weather.

> 延誤的原因是惡劣天氣。

> His ****explanation**** of the delay was clear.

> 他對延誤原因的解釋很清楚。

A reason may be part of an explanation.

25. explanation vs description

****description****

= tells what something is like

****描述****

****explanation****

= tells how or why something happens or what something means

****解釋****

Compare:

> a ****description**** of the experiment

> 對實驗外觀 / 過程的描述

> an ****explanation**** of why the result occurred

> 對結果為何出現的解釋

26. explanation vs definition

****definition****

= states the exact meaning of a word or concept

****定義****

****explanation****

= helps someone understand it more broadly

Compare:

> a ****definition**** of gravity

> 重力的定義

> an ****explanation**** of how gravity works

> 重力如何運作的解釋

27. explanation vs example

****explanation****

= makes the idea clear through words/reasoning

****example****

= specific case illustrating the idea

****例子****

A good teacher often uses both.

This is especially relevant to the passage: Ms. Lau can choose the right explanation, often supported by concrete examples.

28. explanation vs excuse

****excuse****

= reason offered to justify or reduce blame, sometimes weak or dishonest

****藉口 ; 理由****

****explanation****

= neutral account of why something happened

Compare:

> He gave an ****explanation**** for being late.

> 他解釋了遲到的原因。

> He made an ****excuse**** for being late.

> 他為遲到找了個藉口。

The second is more negative.

29. explanation vs justification

****justification****

= reason showing why an action or decision was right, reasonable, or acceptable

****正當理由 ; 辯解****

****explanation****

= broader and does not necessarily defend the action.

Compare:

> She explained why she made the decision.

> 她解釋了為何作出那個決定。

> She gave a justification for the decision.

> 她提出了這個決定的正當理由。

Meaning map

The central concept of **explanation** is:

something that makes another thing understandable

From this develop:

Teaching

clear explanation

→ **清楚解釋**

Cause

explanation for a result

→ **原因 / 解釋**

Accountability

owe someone an explanation

→ **交代**

Science

possible explanation

→ **理論性解釋**

Clarification

more explanation

→ **進一步說明**

The passage uses the teaching/clarification branch:

a student is stuck

→ **the teacher gives the right explanation**

→ **the difficult idea becomes understandable**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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explanation — making something clear	幫助別人理解某個概念、情況或內容的解釋 / 說明
explanation of something	對某個主題、理論、過程等所作的解釋
give an explanation	向別人作出說明或解釋
explanation — reason/cause	用來說明某件事為甚麼發生的原因或說法
explanation for something	對某事件、結果或行為原因的解釋
explanation — account/justification	對自己的行為或某種情況所作的交代 / 說明
ask/demand for an explanation	要求某人解釋其行為、決定或某種情況
scientific/theoretical explanation	用來說明某種現象如何或為何發生的理論 / 機制解釋
possible explanation	對某結果或現象提出的一種合理可能原因
clear explanation	容易理解、能有效消除困惑的解釋
simple explanation	用較簡單方式說明困難內容的解釋
detailed explanation	包含較多細節與完整說明的解釋
without explanation	沒有說明原因或沒有作出交代
owe someone an explanation	有責任向某人解釋或交代
explain	透過資訊、原因或例子使某事變得清楚
explain something to someone	向某人解釋某件事情
explain why/how	說明某事發生的原因 / 運作方式
explanatory	用來解釋或說明內容的
self-explanatory	本身已經很清楚，不需要額外解釋的

Passage recap

> “...she seemed to pull out exactly the right ****explanation****.”

Here:

****explanation**** = ****a way of making a difficult idea understandable****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****解釋****

* ****說明****

* ****解釋方式****

Natural contextual translation:

****每當學生卡住時，她總能拿出最合適的解釋方式。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****explanation****

= ****a statement, account, or way of presenting information that makes something easier to understand****

****解釋；說明；解釋方式****

The key contrast is:

> ****reason****

> → 為甚麼事情發生的原因

versus

> ****explanation****

> → 讓人明白原因、概念或過程的說明

In the passage, the emphasis is clearly on ****understanding****, not on defending or justifying anything.